



GOVERNANCE DOCUMENT

Membership Policy

International Society of Equity Analysts

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RELATED DOCUMENTS	Membership Regulations Member Admission Framework Member Handbook Membership Admission Guide

This document forms part of the official governance framework of the International Society of Equity Analysts (ISEA) and should be read together with the related documents listed above.

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1. Purpose

1.1 The purpose of this Membership Policy is to establish the principles governing membership within the International Society of Equity Analysts ("ISEA").

1.2 This Policy provides the overarching framework for:

- (a) membership admission;
- (b) membership categories;
- (c) professional recognition;
- (d) member obligations;
- (e) membership progression;
- (f) maintenance of professional standards; and
- (g) the administration and governance of membership matters.

1.3 This Policy is intended to ensure that ISEA membership represents a meaningful professional affiliation based on competence, integrity, commitment to continuous development and adherence to professional standards.

2. Scope

2.1 This Policy applies to:

- (a) applicants seeking admission to ISEA;
- (b) existing ISEA Members (Student Members, Associate Members, Members and Fellows);
- (c) candidates seeking advancement between membership categories; and
- (d) committees, officers and personnel involved in membership administration.

2.2 This Policy operates together with the ISEA Membership Regulations and the Membership Framework.

2.3 The Membership Regulations establish the binding rules governing ISEA membership and shall apply except to the extent that this Policy expressly states an intention to override, amend or depart from a provision of the Membership Regulations.

An inconsistency between this Policy and the Membership Regulations shall not, by itself, constitute an override or amendment of the Membership Regulations. Where this Policy is intended to override, amend or depart from a provision of the Membership Regulations, the relevant provision of this Policy shall state that intention expressly and identify the provision of the Membership Regulations affected.

3. Membership Philosophy

3.1 ISEA recognises equity research as a specialised professional discipline requiring technical knowledge, analytical capability, independent judgement and ethical conduct.

3.2 ISEA membership is intended to recognise individuals who demonstrate professional competence and commitment to the advancement of equity analysis.

3.3 Membership is not intended to be merely a subscription, networking benefit or general association membership. ISEA membership represents professional recognition granted following satisfaction of defined admission requirements.

3.4 ISEA seeks to maintain membership standards that promote:

- (a) analytical excellence;
- (b) research integrity;
- (c) independent professional judgement;
- (d) ethical conduct;

- (e) lifelong professional development; and
- (f) contribution to the global equity research profession.

4. Membership Principles

4.1 Merit-Based Admission

ISEA membership shall be determined based on demonstrated professional competence, qualifications, experience, conduct and suitability.

4.2 Professional Integrity

Members must act honestly, independently and ethically in all professional activities associated with equity research and investment analysis.

4.3 Continuous Development

ISEA recognises that professional competence requires ongoing learning and development throughout a member's career.

4.4 Inclusive Professional Recognition

ISEA seeks to recognise professionals from diverse educational, geographic and career backgrounds while maintaining consistent professional standards.

4.5 Protection of Professional Designations

ISEA shall protect the integrity and reputation of its membership classes, post-nominals and professional designations.

5. Membership Categories

5.1 ISEA maintains membership categories designed to recognise different levels of professional development, experience, achievement and contribution to the equity research profession.

5.2 The membership categories of ISEA shall include:

- (a) **Student Member** — for individuals undertaking relevant education, training or early professional development activities relating to equity research, investment analysis or related disciplines;
- (b) **Associate Member** — for individuals who have commenced or are actively transitioning into professional practice in equity research, investment analysis or related disciplines, but who do not yet satisfy the experience, competency or assessment requirements for admission as a Member of the International Society of Equity Analysts (MISEA);
- (c) **Member of the International Society of Equity Analysts ("MISEA")** — for individuals who demonstrate the professional competence, experience and ethical standards required for recognition as an equity analyst professional; and
- (d) **Fellow of the International Society of Equity Analysts ("FISEA")** — for individuals who demonstrate exceptional professional achievement, experience, leadership or contribution to the equity research profession.

5.3 Each membership category represents a distinct level of engagement, recognition and professional standing within ISEA and shall be subject to separate eligibility requirements.

5.4 Admission to Student Member or Associate Member categories does not, by itself, confer entitlement to use any professional designation or post-nominal unless expressly authorised by ISEA.

5.5 The detailed requirements applicable to each membership category, including eligibility criteria, admission requirements, rights, benefits, progression pathways and renewal obligations, shall be prescribed in the Membership Regulations and the Membership Framework.

6. Admission Principles

6.1 ISEA shall assess applicants based on a combination of:

- (a) qualifications;
- (b) professional experience;
- (c) technical competency;
- (d) research capability;
- (e) ethical standing; and
- (f) professional judgement.

6.2 ISEA may require applicants to undertake assessments, submit evidence of professional capability, provide references, participate in interviews or complete other admission requirements determined appropriate by ISEA.

6.3 ISEA reserves the right to refuse admission where an applicant does not satisfy the required standards or where admission would adversely affect the reputation or integrity of ISEA.

7. Research Integrity and Professional Standards

7.1 ISEA recognises that the credibility of the equity research profession depends upon the independence and authenticity of professional analysis.

7.2 Applicants and Members must ensure that submitted research and professional work represents their own analysis, judgement and professional contribution.

7.3 ISEA does not prohibit the use of legitimate professional tools, including research databases, analytical software and technology solutions, provided that the Member remains responsible for the accuracy, independence and integrity of their work.

7.4 ISEA may take action where an applicant or Member engages in plagiarism, misrepresentation, fabrication, unethical conduct or other behaviour inconsistent with professional standards.

8. Member Obligations

8.1 Members are expected to:

- (a) comply with the ISEA Charter, Regulations, Policies, Framework and Procedures;
- (b) maintain professional integrity;
- (c) comply with applicable ethical standards adopted by ISEA;
- (d) maintain appropriate professional competence;
- (e) complete continuing professional development requirements where applicable; and
- (f) protect the reputation of ISEA.

9. Membership Renewal and Continuation

9.1 Membership is subject to ongoing compliance with ISEA requirements.

9.2 Membership renewal does not occur automatically and may be subject to:

- (a) payment of applicable fees;
- (b) compliance with professional obligations;
- (c) completion of required professional development; and
- (d) satisfaction of any continuing membership requirements.

9.3 ISEA may suspend, restrict or terminate membership where a Member fails to comply with applicable requirements.

10. Recognition and Advancement

- 10.1** ISEA recognises professional advancement through progression between membership categories.
- 10.2** Advancement is not automatic and requires evidence that the applicant satisfies the requirements applicable to the higher membership category.
- 10.3** The granting of a higher designation represents recognition of demonstrated professional achievement and contribution.

11. Administration of Membership

- 11.1** The Governing Council is responsible for the governance and oversight of membership matters.
- 11.2** The Governing Council may delegate membership administration, assessment and review functions to committees, officers or other authorised persons.
- 11.3** ISEA may establish procedures, guidelines and frameworks necessary for the effective administration of membership.

12. Fees and Membership Revenue

- 12.1** Membership fees are payable in accordance with requirements determined by ISEA.
- 12.2** Membership fees constitute general revenue of ISEA and shall be applied in accordance with ISEA's financial governance requirements.
- 12.3** Payment of membership fees does not create any entitlement to admission, renewal, designation or continued membership.

13. Review of Policy

- 13.1** This Policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure continued alignment with:
 - (a) professional standards;
 - (b) industry expectations;
 - (c) the strategic objectives of ISEA; and
 - (d) the development of the equity research profession.
- 13.2** The Governing Council may amend this Policy from time to time.